Protensia Hadunka

updated October 2026

Contact Information

Department of Business
University of Tennessee Southern
119 Martin Hall
Pulaski, TN 38478

Phone: +1 (931) 424 2055
hprotens@utsouthern.edu
website

Education

Ph.D., Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign 2026
M.Sc., Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign 2020
B.Sc., Agricultural Economics, The University of Zambia, Lusaka, Main campus, Zambia 2015

Research Areas

Environmental Economics Agricultural Economics
Development Economics

Current Position

Assistant Professor of Business, University of Tennessee Southern, TN - D.W. Johnston School of Business Aug 2026 - To date

Relevant Work Experience

Adjunct Faculty (Micro & Macro Economics) – Illinois Wesleyan University (IWU), School of Business & Economics, IL Fall 2025

Instructor & Teaching Assistant (Micro & Macro Economics, Environmental Economics, Applied Statistical Methods, Intro to Agribusiness Mgt) – University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, IL Jul 2017 - May 2026

Teaching Assistant (Machine Learning for Applied Economists) – University of Bonn, Germany Jun 2021 - Aug 2021

Co-Principal Investigator, International Growth Center – Climate change and deforestation : A think tank supervised by the University of Oxford and London School of Economics Jan 2025 - Jul 2025

Co-Principal Investigator, International Growth Center – Technology adoption, grain storage and climate resilience: A think tank supervised by the University of Oxford and London School of Economics Jan 2025 - Jul 2025

Principal Investigator, International Growth Center – FRA project: A think tank supervised by the University of Oxford and London School of Economics, Remote Dec 2023 - Feb 2024

Research Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, IL Jul 2017 - May 2026

Data Quality Controller, Musika Development Initiative, World Food Program, and Business Development Services Africa - SME, Zambia Oct 2016 - Nov 2019

Research Intern, Musika, Zambia Dec 2016 - May 2017

Research Intern, Indaba Agricultural Policy Research Institute (IAPRI) Sep 2016 - Dec 2016

Field Supervisor, International Maize and Wheat Improvement Center (CYMMIT) Oct 2015 - Dec 2015

Publications

Hadunka, P. & Okada Da Silva (2026) "How does the availability of alternative livelihoods influence households' reliance on charcoal as a coping strategy?" - *World Development.*

Ordonez, 0., **Hadunka, P.,** Rossi, G., & Baylis, K. (2025)."When crops fail, forests follow: Agricultural shocks and deforestation in Zambia" - **Co-first author** *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS).*

Xiong, S., **Hadunka, P.,**, Mulenga, B. P., Rufin, P., & Estes, L (2026)."Is field size an indicator of farm size in smallholder-dominated croplands?" *Environmental research: Food Systems.*

Wang, J., Konar, M., **Hadunka, P.,** & Mulenga, B.P. (2026)."Dietary Transitions and Nutritional Dynamics in Zambia and Tanzania under Urbanization" *Agriculture & Food Security.*

Wang, J., Konar, M., Anderson, P., **Hadunka, P.,** & Mulenga, B.P. (2025). "Exploring the Impact of Short-Term and Long-Term Climate Shocks on Crop Diversification in Zambia: Insights from Household- and District-Level Observations" *Climate Risk Management.*

Molitor, C., Cohen, J., Lewin, G., Cognac, S., **Hadunka, P.,** Proctor, J., & Carleton, T. (2025). "Monitoring Maize Yield Variability over Space and Time with Unsupervised Satellite Imagery Features" *Remote Sensing*

Wang, J., Konar, M., Baylis, K., Estes, L., **Hadunka, P.,** Caylor, K., & Xiong, S. (2023)."Potential impacts of transportation infrastructure improvements to maize and cassava supply chains in Zambia" *Environmental Research: Infrastructure and Sustainability*

Mulenga, B. P., **Hadunka, P.,** & Richardson, R. B. (2017) ."Rural households' participation in charcoal production in Zambia: Does agricultural productivity play a role?." *Journal of Forest Economics* 26, 56-62.

In review

Hadunka, P., Songsermsawas, T., & Mulenga, B.P. (2026) "Climate resilience in agriculture: Can Climate Smart Agriculture counteract rainfall shocks?" - *Agricultural Systems - R & R.*

Hadunka, P., Baylis, K., Green, R & Zimmer, A. (2026) "The effect of invasive pests on food security: An understudied effect of climate change" *Food Policy.*

Xiong, S., Wanjing, L., **Hadunka, P.,** Khallaghi. S., Abedi. R., Yao-Ting. Y., Chilenga. A., Khan. A., Potapov. P.,& Estes, L (2026) "High spatial and temporal resolution analyses reveal the changing characteristics of African croplands" *Global Change Biology.*

Cecil, M., Estes, L., Caylor, K., **Hadunka, P.,** Evans, T., Chilenga, A., Gitonga, J., & Wolf, A. (2026)." Advantages and Limitations of Multiple Sensors for Smallholder Maize Land Surface Phenology Estimation" *Remote Sensing of Environment.*

Sullivan, J., Baylis, K., **Hadunka, P.,** & Konar, M., (2025)." Urban Legend: Disparities in Household Diets and Food Security Along a Rural-Urban Continuum" *Global Environmental Change.*

Working Papers and Research in Progress

Hadunka, P., Hardie, R & Figueiredo Walter, T. (2026) "Coping or Collapsing? How Charcoal Fuels a Poverty - Deforestation Feedback Loop".

Hadunka, P., Baylis, K., Cardell, L., & Michelson, H. (2026) "Crop Choice as a Coping Strategy under Spatial Exposure to Pests".

Park, H., & **Hadunka, P.** (2026) "What causes adverse outcomes in the maize markets?".

Abedi, R., Chakraborty, T., **Hadunka, P.,** Alemohammad, H., & Estes, L (2026) "Learning Tillage Practices Under Spatial Uncertainty".

Hadunka, P., Baylis, K., & Thornton, R. (2025) "Does the providing efficient transportation improve the price knowledge among rural households? Evidence from Malawi" - RCT.

Teaching

Applied Microeconomics (90 Undergraduates), Environmental Economics (70 Undergraduates), Macroeconomics (35 Undergraduates), Applied Statistical methods, Data Analytics (90 Undergraduates) & Machine Learning for Applied Economists (20 PhD students)

University-wide "List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent (Exceptional)" (Fall 2025), IWU

University-wide "List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent" (Spring 2024), UIUC

University-wide "List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent" (Fall 2023), UIUC

University-wide "List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent" (Spring 2023), UIUC

University-wide "List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent" (Fall 2020), UIUC

Policy Reports

Hadunka, P., Hardie, R., Waller, A & Figueiredo Walter, T. (2025) "Climate shocks and charcoal production in Zambia" International Growth Center, Policy brief.

Hadunka, P & Teschemacher, C. (2024) "The effect of Zambia's Food Reserve Agency on agricultural market outcomes" International Growth Center, Project report.

Hadunka, P & Janzen, J. (2024) "Weather Shocks and Seasonal Commodity Market Returns: Evidence from Zambia's Maize Market" University of Illinois at Urbana-Chapaign, farmdoc.

Kasanda, E., **Hadunka, P.**, Lubinga, F., Mumba, K., Sakala, M., Arneson, S., Harper, T & Sichilima, T. (2017) "A Needs Assessment of Rural Agribusinesses: The Commercial Viability of SMEs" Musika Development Initiatives, Zambia.

Kasanda, E.,, Chanda, J, **Hadunka, P** & Sichilima, T. (2017) "The Status of Smallholder Dairy Markets and Farmers' Perceptions of Formal Markets in Western Province" Musika Development Initiatives, Zambia.

Chela, J & **Hadunka, P.** (2017) "A Qualitative Needs Assessment of Village Chicken Producers in Southern Province" Musika Development Initiatives, Zambia.

External Grants

International Growth Center	Technology adoption, grain storage and climate resilience - RCT (Fall 2025)
International Growth Center	Climate change and deforestation (Fall 2024)
International Growth Center	Evaluating the Food and Reserve Agency (Spring 2024)
National Science Foundation	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Summer 2023)
Travel Grant	Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting (Summer 2022)
Travel Grant	Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting (Summer 2023)

Fellowships, Grants and Academic Awards

Travel Grant	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Summer 2023)
Travel Grant	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Spring 2023)
Travel Grant	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Summer 2022)
Jean and John Due Fellowship	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Spring 2020)
University Fellowship	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Fall 2019)
Morgan Endowment	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Summer 2020)
Dunn and Linse Fellowship	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Fall 2017)

Best Undergraduate Thesis (got published after graduation), The University of Zambia (2015)

Presentations

2026: American Geophysical Union (San Francisco, CA) - Presented by Rahebe Abedi

2024: Led a discussion with senior officials from the Presidential Delivery Unit, Ministry of Agriculture, International Growth Center, and Food and Reserve Agency (FRA) on reforming the FRA (Lusaka, Zambia) - Recommendation was implemented into policy.

2023: Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Portland, ME)

2023: Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting (Washington, DC)

2022: Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting (Anaheim, CA)

2022: Center for the Study of Africa Economies-University of Oxford (UK) (virtual)

2022: Midwest International Economic Development Conference (Minneapolis, MN)

2022: Sustainability and Development Initiative Conference (Virtual)

2019: Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting (Atlanta, GA)

Service and Leadership

Member of the University of Tennessee Southern General Education Committee (2026 - Present)
Member of the University of Tennessee SouthernTurner Center Internal Advisory Committee (2026 - Present)
Member of the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Graduate Programs Committee (2018 - 2025)

Abstract reviewer - Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (Annual meetings) - 2022, 2023

Guest Editor - Frontiers in Environmental Economics (special issue)

Additional Information

Software proficiency: Stata, R, python, LATEX, GitHub, GIS, GAMS, Microsoft Office
Languages: English, Tonga (native), Bemba, Lozi, Nyanja, and Shona (Basic)

Professional References

Kathy Baylis, Ph.D. (Chair)
Professor
University of California, Santa Barbara
baylis@ucsb.edu

Hope Michelson, Ph.D.
Professor
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
hopecm@illinois.edu

Shadi Atallah, Ph.D.
Associate Professor
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
satallah@illinois.edu

Brian McCannon, Ph.D.
Professor
Illinois Wesleyan University
bmccanno@iwu.edu